Discovery · Service

UX research · Unicity mobile checkout

Role: UX researcher, UX designer
Timeline: Mar 2023 – Jul 2023 (5 months)
Team: Product Manager, Software engineers, Customer support

As the sole researcher on a cross-functional team, I led research to uncover pain points in the checkout flow, identifying design opportunities to streamline the user journey. This project was presented to the Head of Product and Head of Engineering, leading to the prioritization of key improvements in the next development cycle.

Problem

Many users abandoned their cart for checkout, even though many consumer retailers make the flow easy for users to checkout as a guest user. To uncover the root causes, I conducted research to understand user behaviors, pain points, and motivations during the checkout process.

How might we help e-retailers empower users like Mia who is in a hurry, with the priority to buy at once or buy, and ensure a return for the retailer in the process?

Research goals

1. To examine guest checkout vs. drop off when checking out as a guest.
2. Learn what payment methods buyers in Thailand expect to see, and why.
3. Understand what buyers want to see after paying for their purchase.
4. Check how the new UI version that I'll make can improve from the existing page.

Research questions

- Do the mandatory inputs in create an account, or searching for either check and find and a password error?
- Are there delivery and payment options that are not clear or don't provide users with their needs?
- When do buyers choose cash, QR code or bank transfer, and what makes them trust each?
- Do buyers prefer to receive digital receipts or physical receipts, and why?
- After paying, what's updates matter most: confirmation, delivery tracking or delivery?

Methods

Mixed	Mixed	Mixed	Mixed
Heuristic review	**Competitive review**	**Customer interviews**	**Usability test**	**Checkout analytics**
Method through the current platform's checkout against usability principles to identify potential friction points.	Compare mobile checkout flows of 3 e-commerce platforms to find industry standards and best practices.	8 in-depth interviews with mid-buyers, regular buyers and abandoned cart users to understand their motivations.	6 facilitated sessions on prototype with the 3 complete prototype, observing task completion and errors.	Google Analytics to identify drop-off points and conversion rates.

Key findings + design responses

Finding	Impact	Design response
Signing up is missed into placing the order Users are forced to create an account before checking out, causing them the registration. **Response:** Do Guest Always the fields and, with a log in link to fill for returning buyers.	High	**The tool is easy to have an a phone** Users are forced to create an account before checking out, causing them the registration. **Response:** a Facebook seamless as Oh Canvas, and the amount on the fast. Facebook.	High	**No sense of progress** Users are forced to create an account before checking out, causing them the registration. **Response:** Show steps (Cancel, Shipping, Payment) with a stepper you can be back through	Medium
The referral field competes for attention Users are forced to create an account before checking out, causing them the registration. **Response:** the referral code and redeem coupon on the UI now.	Medium	**No clear path when payment fails** Users are forced to create an account before checking out, causing them the registration. **Response:** Fill the missing card the Payment fails, with the support card was been resolved	Medium	**The primary shape on "enter promo"** Users are forced to create an account before checking out, causing them the registration. **Response:** Fill QR code confirmation, order details, receipt, tracking, delivery and a stepper is updated flow	Low

Hypotheses to validate

- **H1** Adding a guest checkout option will reduce abandonment by at least 15% within 3 months after launch.
- **H2** Offering QR code and bank transfer as options will reduce abandonment at payment. Because drop-off is all by buyers by method.
- **H3** A step tracking with an "arrived by day 2 after" reminder. Because, support contacts will reduce.
- **H4** Users have a clearer understanding of their payment options and delivery status, after the proposed flows.

Usability test tasks

1. Buy an item and checkout as a guest user (no account creation).
2. Pay using "bank or QR code" from the payment.
3. Find where to track your order after purchase.
4. Find where to add a promo code.
5. Find and view your order history and delivery status.

Success metrics

Primary (Qualitative)
Task success rate: 80%+

Time to pay
Under 2 minutes

Task success rate 80%
Users can complete checkout

Support contact/return rate
Lower than current baseline

Tracked using the current baseline

Findings: 5 P0 issues (mandatory account creation, lack of payment options, no progress indicator, missing delivery tracking, and unclear promo code placement) were prioritized for redesign, resulting in the proposed solutions.

Next step: Usability testing

Personas - who checks out with Unicity

These fictional buyers (part that can be made) are designed from. The research questions and will be updated after the customer interviews. Here is the primary persona user:

Primary Persona · Secondary Persona

Nok · Active
Age: 28 · Office worker · Bangkok
Tech comfort: Uses mobile banking and shopping apps daily

"I just want to buy it in my phone during lunch. Don't make me create an account first."

Goals
- Buy a new phone
- Pay in installments
- Track delivery status

Needs
- Fast, simple checkout
- Clear payment options
- Delivery time estimate

Frustrations
- Long forms to create account
- Unclear delivery fees
- Hidden costs at the end

Behaviors
- Shops on mobile during breaks
- Compares prices before buying
- Prefers fast over free delivery

Motivation: Fast and easy
Tech comfort: Low
Age group: 25–34

Somchai · Active
Age: 45 · Shop owner · Chiang Mai
Tech comfort: Uses LINE and Facebook daily, new to online shopping

"Some how we start month, and let me wonder and tell me when it arrives."

Goals
- Buy stock for his shop
- Pay by bank transfer
- Get a receipt for records

Needs
- Clear bank transfer instructions
- Receipt by email or LINE
- Confirmation that payment went through

Frustrations
- Not sure if payment went through
- Can't find order history
- Too many steps to buy more stock

Behaviors
- Buys in bulk every few weeks
- Checks LINE before anything else
- Asks friends for advice before buying

Motivation: Fast and reliable
Tech comfort: Medium
Age group: 35–44

Phy · Active
Age: 22 · Student · Khon Kaen
Tech comfort: Uses mobile banking and shopping apps daily

"My customers ask me where their order is. I need a receipt and a tracking number."

Goals
- Buy stock for her shop
- Pay by bank transfer
- Get a receipt for records

Needs
- Clear bank transfer instructions
- Receipt by email or LINE
- Confirmation that payment went through

Frustrations
- Not sure if payment went through
- Can't find order history
- Too many steps to buy more stock

Behaviors
- Buys in bulk every few weeks
- Checks LINE before anything else
- Asks friends for advice before buying

Motivation: Fast and reliable
Tech comfort: Medium
Age group: 35–44

Design principles
1. **Speed over everything** — Minimize steps. Every extra screen is a chance to lose the sale.
2. **Trust is earned** — Show clear payment info, delivery details, and order confirmation.
3. **Clarity over cleverness** — No hidden fees, no surprises. Total cost visible before the last step.

Pay the way you already pay
Users QR code and bank transfer through payment, and the amount is the main.

The order doesn't end at payment
Receipt, tracking, delivery and order help are the way, so no need to ask support on the checkout.

Persona, research, and customer journey map, and wireframes. Prototype Flows with updates from the customer interviews before starting the prototype for the platform.

Customer journey map

Based on the persona, I created a customer journey map to visualize Nok's emotions, pain points, and opportunities across the checkout process.

SCENARIO · STORIES

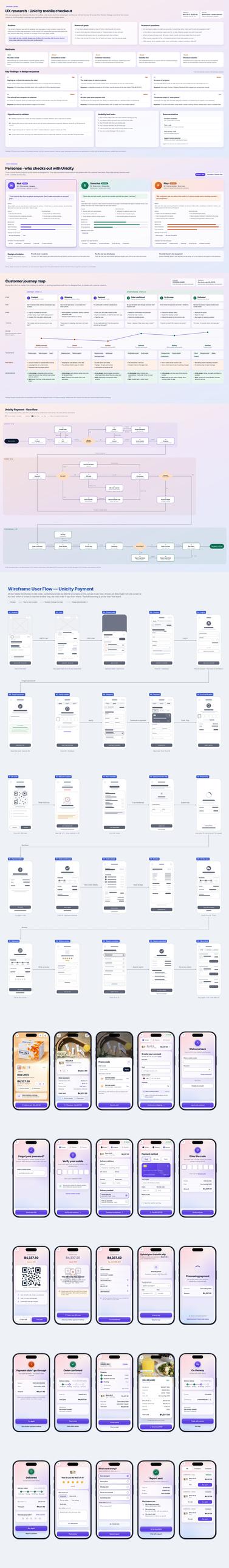
Discovery	**Checkout**	**Payment**	**Order confirmed**	**On the way**	**Delivered**
Nok sees a phone she wants on Instagram and opens the app.	Nok adds the phone to cart and clicks "Buy Now".	Nok selects a payment method and pays.	Nok sees the order confirmation and receipt.	Nok checks the app to see if her phone has shipped.	Nok receives the package and opens it.
ACTIONS	• Opens app • Searches for the phone • Reads reviews and compares prices	• Clicks "Buy Now" • Logs in or creates an account • Enters name, address, and phone number • Chooses free delivery at pickup	• Selects payment method • Enters card details • Confirms the order	• Receives the confirmation email • Checks the order number • Saves the receipt	• Checks the app for shipping updates • Waits for the delivery • Tracks the parcel
THINKING	"Is this a real deal or a scam?" "Should I buy it now or wait?"	"This is taking too long, and where will I get it from?"	"Is my card safe? Did the payment actually go through?"	"Is it all set or will I have to do more?"	"Will it arrive on time?"	"Is it here. It's inside. Let's see it!"
FEELING	Excited but cautious	Curious	Anxious	Relieved	Waiting	Satisfied
TOUCHPOINTS	Instagram Search Product page	Cart Checkout page Login	Payment page Banking app	Confirmation page Email inbox	Tracking page Courier website	Parcel Delivery driver	Unboxing
PAIN POINTS	• Account creation is required before buying • Delivery fee is hidden until the end • Password rules are never upfront	• Checking the app appears at the top • Payment failed but no guest access, order lost	• Some sites ask you to create an account • Loading the app is too slow • Leaving the app to pay is risky	• No clear date or tell of day • Account is forced to login again	• Not sure when it will ship • Tracking number is not working properly	• Receiving a heavy expecting a package • Not delivered by the agreed date	• Not sure how to return • Package arrives damaged
OPPORTUNITIES	• Let the buyer start from the phone page • Show delivery fee upfront • Let the buyer start from the phone page • Allow guest checkout	• Let the buyer start from the phone page • Allow guest checkout • Save the buyer's cart	• Let the buyer start from the phone page • Allow guest checkout • Save the buyer's cart	• Let the buyer start from the phone page • Allow guest checkout • Save the buyer's cart	• Let the buyer start from the phone page • Allow guest checkout • Save the buyer's cart	• Let the buyer start from the phone page • Allow guest checkout • Save the buyer's cart	• Let the buyer start from the phone page • Allow guest checkout • Save the buyer's cart

Findings: Nok's journey is mostly positive until checkout, where she loses trust and feels anxious. Payment and delivery tracking are the biggest pain points. Guest checkout and clearer delivery info are the biggest opportunities.

Unicity Payment · User flow

Author: Nok Somchai · Last updated: 12 Mar 2023 · Status: Draft · Version: 1.0

This flow maps every screen and decision point in the payment process, from entering the amount to receiving the final receipt.



Wireframe User Flow — Unicity Payment

All four flows, mid-fidelity, in black and white. Dashboard and Add Card are the only screens I'll use color. Arrows are direct taps from one screen to the next, names a screen to reach/find another way, the note under it says how. The full terminology is on the User flow board.

Screen · Tap to reach screen · System change · Image placeholder

Flow 1 — Buy a product

Product page
Add to cart
Add to cart
Cart
Checkout
Checkout
Log in
Log in
Log in
Sign up
Sign up
Sign up
Start of the flow
Tap regular Price of an 18 carat rolex here
Optional wheel - tap to 10
Price 10 - Checkout
Price 10 - Checkout
Tap log in
Tap sign up
Tap sign up
Tap log in
Tap log in
Tap sign up
Tap sign up
Tap log in
Tap log in
Tap sign up
Tap sign up
Tap log in